Tadeo de Jesús Esquivel Blanco

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EDUCATION

Instituto de Biología, Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México, México 02/2025-Present
MSc. In **Biological Sciences (Systematics)** | GPA 9.60/10

- •Diploma in **Paleontology**. ENAH-UNAM, México. 08/2026-Present
- •Exchange program Freie Universität Berlin, Germany | Msc. **Biodiversity, Evolution, Ecology** 10/2025-03/2026

Facultad de Ciencias, Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México, México 09/2019-12/2024
BSc. In **Biology** | GPA 9.67/10 (Hons.)

- •Exchange program Universidad de Oviedo, Spain | BSc. In **Biology** 09/2022-03/2023

WORK AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, *Colección Nacional de Moluscos*, Instituto de Biología, UNAM 10/2021-Present
• Conducted taxonomic inventory, identification and classification of over 5,000 gastropod specimens.
• Evaluated urbanization effects and species introductions on Natural Protected Areas.
• Collaborated in the preparation and curation of exhibits for public outreach and scientific communication**.**
• Addressed sampling gaps, uncovering new national records and species potentially new to science.
• Authored undergraduate thesis from self-organized research project, awarded Best Biology Thesis in Faculty.

IUCN Red List Reviewer & Technical Advisor, International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) 04/2026
• Assessed conservation metrics determining Red List inclusion, providing critical scientific baselines for policymakers.
• Co-secured the prestigious Mohamed bin Zayed Species Conservation grant

Curatorial Volunteer, *Museum für Naturkunde*, Berlin 10/2025-03/2026
• Identified and digitized historical samples of endangered/extinct snail species affected by human-driven extinction.
• Cataloged and digitized historic type specimens and series (Family Partulidae), preserving fragile nomenclatural records
• Verified historical specimens and topotypes to resolve taxonomic uncertainties.

Museum Guide & Science Communicator, *Museo Universum & Social Media Platforms* 02/2022-08/2022
•Delivered educational tours on palaeontology for diverse and inclusive visitor groups.
•Co-founded "BioCuriozoos" platform, directing science communication strategies to foster public environmental literacy.

SOCIAL SERVICE AND VOLUNTEERING

United Nations Online Volunteer, *Regional Bureau for Latin America and the Caribbean,* UNDP 06/2026-07/2026
• Performed geospatial mapping of territorial elements to support regional open data disaster prevention initiatives.

Project specialist, *Instituto de Ciencias del Mar y Limnología,* UNAM 03/2023-04/2024
• Constructed a historical sample database to assess water quality risks affecting vulnerable fishing communities.
• Assisted in limnological field sampling to evaluate the socio-ecological crisis impacting local fishermen.
• Awarded the "Gustavo Baz Prada" Award for outstanding community engagement and technical contributions.

HONORS

• **Best Thesis Award** "Carlos Enrique Chávez Solís 2025" *Facultad de Ciencias, UNAM*: Academic annual distinction that seeks to recognize biology students who have maintained an impeccable academic record and produced high-quality work, motivating new generations of biologists to redouble their efforts and encouraging them to set increasingly ambitious goals while undertaking solutions to national challenges.
• **Social Service Award** "Gustavo Baz Prada 2024". *Facultad de Ciencias, UNAM*: Annual distinction that recognizes students through their participation with a social impact, aimed at disadvantaged populations and designed to help improve their living conditions, contributing to the country's economic, social, and educational development.
•**Graduated with honors**. *Facultad de Ciencias, UNAM*: Highest academic distinction conferred upon graduation, requiring a top GPA, timely completion, and unanimous distinction by the five-member examination jury during the thesis oral defense.

PUBLICATIONS

• **Esquivel Blanco T**., Rangel Velasco R. & Naranjo-García E. (Manuscript) Snail Microhabitats in Cancún: The Case Study of the Non-Marine Mollusks of Urban Park 'Kabah'. *Urban Ecosystems*.

• Rangel Velasco R., Soto K., **Esquivel Blanco T**., Naranjo-García E., Camacho, Y. (Manuscript) The native freshwater snails of Central America: update checklist, study status and endemicity

• **Esquivel Blanco T.,** Rangel Velasco R. & E. Naranjo-García. (Under Review). First records of the non-native predator *Tomostele* musaecola in Mexico: Potential dispersal in Cancún through soil tampering. *Folia Malacologica*.

Rangel Velasco R., **Esquivel Blanco T**., & Naranjo García E. (Under Review). Nuevos registros y respuestas ecológicas de gasterópodos de agua dulce a la integridad del hábitat en el Lago de Tecocomulco, Hidalgo, México. *Limnetica*

• **2026**. Rangel Velasco R**., Esquivel Blanco T**., & Naranjo García E. La Malacofauna de la Ciudad de México: Un Registro Histórico y Actual. *Acta Zoológica Mexicana 42*(1), 1–13. https://doi.org/10.21829/azm.2026.4212799

• **2025. Esquivel Blanco T.,** Rangel Velasco R., Ortigosa D. & Naranjo-García E. Non-native freshwater mollusks in Mexico: current status and new records. *Hidrobiológica 35* (3): 225 230.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

• **Fulbright-García Robles STEM Regional Scholarship***, COMEXUS*	09/2027-09/2030
• **Species Conservation Grant** (Co-lead) *The Mohamed bin Zayed Species Conservation Fund*	10/2026-03/2027
• **National Graduate Scholarship***, Secretaría de Ciencia, Humanidades, Tecnología e Innovación*	02/2025-02/2027
• **Direktaustausch Student Exchange Scholarship,** *Freie Universität Berlin*	10/2025-03/2026
• **PAEP Graduate Mobility Grant** (Long-Term), *Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México*	10/2025-03/2026
• **Molluscan Forum Travel Grant,** *The Malacological Society of London*	11/2026
• **World Congress of Malacology Travel Grant**, *UNITAS Malacologica*	08/2025
• **High-Performance Graduation Scholarship**, *Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México*	10/2024-12/2024
• **DGECI International Mobility Scholarship,** *Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México*	09/2022-03/2023

FIRST AUTHORED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

• **2026. XIII Congreso Latinoamericano de Malacología**. Oral Presentation. "*Sin miedo a las alturas: dinámica vertical y estacional de los caracoles terrestres en el bosque tropical de Los Tuxtlas, México*". Cartagena, Colombia.

• **2025. Molluscan Forum**. Oral presentation. "*Stories from the Understory: Land Snails in an Endangered Mexican Rainforest Ecosystem*". Natural History Museum, London, UK.

• **2025. PartWiss 2025**. Oral Presentation. "*I have friends everywhere: Citizen science and invasive freshwater mollusks in Mexico*". Leipzig, Germany.

• **2025. XXII World Congress of Malacology**. Oral presentation: "*Who Is to Blame? First Records of the Non-Native Predatory Snail Tomostele musaecola in Mexico and Implications for Its Potential Spread in Cancún*". São Paulo, Brazil.

•**2025. XXII World Congress of Malacology**. Poster: "*Beyond Beaches and Resorts: Molluscan Biodiversity and Sampling Gaps in Cancún, México*". São Paulo, Brazil.

• **2025**. **XVII Reunión Nacional de Malacología y Conquiliología y 58th Annual Meeting of the Western Society of Malacologists**. Oral presentation: "*Inventario taxonómico de caracoles continentales del Área Natural Protegida 'Parque Ecológico Kabah', Quintana Roo, México*". Universidad de Sonora, México.

• **2024. XXVI Congreso Nacional de Zoología**. Poster: "*Un poco de todo: Nuevos registros de caracoles marinos, terrestres y dulceacuícolas en un parque urbano en Cancún*". Universidad de Colima, México.

• **2024. XXVI Congreso Nacional de Zoología**. Oral presentation: "*Microambientes urbanos: Un análisis de las comunidades de caracoles terrestres en el Parque Kabah, Quintana Roo*". Universidad de Colima, México.

• **2024. XXVI Congreso Nacional de Zoología**. Oral presentation: "*Caracoles marinos y terrestres de cuevas (cenotes) en Playa del Carmen, Quintana Roo*". Universidad de Colima, México.

• **2024. 1st Pan-American Congress on Invasive and Non-Native Aquatic Species**. Oral presentation: "*Moluscos dulceacuícolas no-nativos de México: Estado Actual y Nuevos Registros*". Online.

• **2023. XII Congreso Latinoamericano de Malacología**. Oral presentation: "*Registros de moluscos marinos del Parque Urbano Kabah, Cancún, Quintana Roo, México*". Online.

• **2022. XXV Congreso Nacional de Zoología**. Poster: "*Avances en el conocimiento de gasterópodos continentales de Cancún*". Facultad de Ciencias, UNAM. México.

CO-AUTHORED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

• **2025. XXII World Congress of Malacology**. Rangel-Velasco Oral presentation: "*Historical and contemporary record of continental mollusks in Mexico City*". São Paulo, Brazil

• **2025. XXII World Congress of Malacology**. Deneb-Ortigosa Oral presentation: "*Malacology and conchology for everyone: an outreach strategy for Mexico*". São Paulo, Brazil

• **2025. XXII World Congress of Malacology**. Naranjo-Garcia Oral presentation: "*Troglodyte fauna or cave tramps of fauna: Quintana Roo (Mexico*)". São Paulo, Brazil

• **2025**. **XVII Reunión Nacional de Malacología y Conquiliología y 58th Annual Meeting of the Western Society of Malacologists**. Rangel-Velasco Oral presentation: "*Avances preliminares en la revisión taxonómica del género Oxyloma (Succineidae) en México mediante análisis morfológico*". Universidad de Sonora, México.

• **2025**. **XVII Reunión Nacional de Malacología y Conquiliología y 58th Annual Meeting of the Western Society of Malacologists**. Rangel-Velasco Oral presentation: "*El Hidalgo olvidado: moluscos de agua dulce de la laguna de Tecocomulco y su relevancia para la conservación.*". Universidad de Sonora, México.

• **2024. 1er Congreso de Conservación de la Biodiversidad**. Rangel-Velasco Oral presentation: "*No podemos conservar lo que no conocemos: La extinción silenciosa y el estado de conservación de los moluscos continentales*". México.

• **2024. XXVI Congreso Nacional de Zoología**. Naranjo-García Oral presentation: "*Caracoles marinos y terrestres de cuevas (cenotes) en Playa del Carmen, Quintana Roo*". Universidad de Colima.

SCIENTIFIC REPORTS

• **2026** (to be published). *IUCN Red List Freshwater Mollusks from Mexico and Central America*.

• **2024**. *Limnological and Fishery Biological Study of the Fernando Hiriart Balderrama Hydroelectric Dam "Zimapán." Instituto de Ciencias del Mar y Limnología.*

THESES

• **2026.** *Analysis of the terrestrial snail (Mollusca: Gastropoda) communities in the lower canopy of the tropical evergreen forest of Los Tuxtlas, Veracruz, Mexico*. (In progress).

• **2024.** *Taxonomic Inventory of Continental Snails (Mollusca: Gastropoda) from the "Parque Ecológico Kabah" Protected Natural Area, Quintana Roo, Mexico*. (Undergraduate).
https://tesiunamdocumentos.dgb.unam.mx/ptd2024/oct_dic/0863996/Index.html

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

• **IUCN Species Survival Comission**	10/2026-10/2029
• **Unitas Malacologica**	01/2025-Present
• **Sociedad de Malacología de México**	12/2024-Present
• **American Malacological Society**	02/2025-Present
• **Sociedad Mexicana de Zoología**	11/2022-Present
• **Colección Nacional de Moluscos, IB UNAM**	09/2021-Present
• **Museum für Naturkunde, Malacological Collection**	10/2025-03/2025
• **Laboratorio de Limnología, ICMyL UNAM**	03/2023-03/2024

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

• **Software:** IBM SPSS, Primer7, R, RStudio, Python, EstimateS, MEGA7, MrBayes, PAUP*, FigTree, BEAST, QGIS.

• **Languages**: **Spanish**: Native | **English**: Advanced (IELTS Academic C1) | **French**: Basic | **German**: Basic.

REFERENCES

• **Dr. Edna Naranjo García**. Senior Researcher & Collection Manager, Colección Nacional de Moluscos. Instituto de Biología, UNAM. Mexico City, Mexico. naranjo@unam.mx (Undergraduate & MSc Thesis Advisor)

• **Dr. Yasmin Quintana** Manager, Center for Species Survival: Freshwater. Shedd Aquarium. Chicago, IL, USA yquintana@sheddaquarium.org (IUCN Red List Advisor & Collaborator)

• **Dr. Thomas von Rintelen**. Senior Curator. Museum für Naturkunde. Berlin, Germany Thomas.Rintelen@mfn.berlin (Curatorial & Research Supervisor)

• **Dr. Fernando Córdova Tapia** Associate Researcher, Laboratorio de Limnología Instituto de Ciencias del Mar y Limnología, UNAM. Mexico City, Mexico fcordova@cmarl.unam.mx (Social Service & Project Supervisor)